# From reach to a submitted application

*Each stage loses people for a different reason. Name the lever for each drop before launch.*

| | Reached | Engaged | Applications started | Deadline week | Submitted |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 085 ESTIMATE | **Set from plan** | **No 045 rate yet** | **240–300 or 540–670** | **Track % complete** | **130–160 target** |
| 045 PHASE I ACTUAL | Not recorded | 557 site sessions, 97 interest forms (May 26) | 172 at 4 PM on deadline day; not de-duplicated | 10% of starts finished a week out | 93 submitted; a third on the last day |
| CONVERTS TO NEXT | **Set from your data** | **No 045 rate yet** | **54% or 24%** | **A third land on the last day** | **96% eligible (045)** |
| WHY PEOPLE DROP | Wrong audience, or the message misses the segment | Interest without a reason to act now | A registration form or long application adds a step | Teams stall on hard sections and run out of time | Platform strain and late uploads on deadline day |
| LEVER · OWNER | Named target list; partners qualified · Marketing, checked by PM QA (WF 15) | Info session, office hours, matchmaking; capture contacts · Marketing + APM | Personal nudges to high-likelihood starters · APM | Reminders tiered by progress; help desk staffed · APM | Load test; backup path; deadline-day cover · APM |

**THE NUMBER THAT DECIDES IT**

Started to submitted. 54% is the 045 upper bound from records; 24% applies if 390 starts is right. Confirm with the de-duplicated CoLab export.

**ASK THE CLIENT**

Which agency channels will amplify, and can we contact past entrants? Does a registration form sit before the application?

# From submitted to selected, with a record at every cut

> *Every cut needs a written rule and a named decider. That is what makes a selection defensible.*

| | Submitted | Eligibility screen | Reviewer scoring | Reconciliation | Judges decide | Verify and notify |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **085 ESTIMATE** | **130–160** | **125–155 at 96%** | **~465 reviews** | **Ranked list** | **40 winners** | **40 notified** |
| **WHAT HAPPENS** | Platform closes; late and failed uploads handled by the published rule | Human plus light AI checks on self-reported items; above 300 entries, revisit with the client | [3] reviewers per entry score each criterion 0–6 against written statements | Scores 2+ points apart discussed, not averaged; comments kept for teams | Minimum score, cap on winners, tie-breakers, published policy factors | Eligibility re-checked, payee details collected, private notice, then announcement |
| **WHO DECIDES** | Rules decide; APM applies | FedTech screens; client confirms any disqualification | Reviewers score; they do not select | FedTech moderates; review lead signs | The agency's appointed judges | PM, with client sign-off on the payee list |
| **RECORD KEPT** | Submission log with timestamps | Screening log, reason per exclusion | Scores and comments | Reconciliation notes | Signed decision memo | Confirmed payee list |
| **045 LESSON** | A third arrived on the last day | 89 of 93 eligible; 4 out on citizenship or location | 18 of 49 reviews in at the soft deadline | AI-use policy set mid-review; set it first | Name the judges and check dates at kickoff | Feedback to teams after the announcement |

**THE NUMBER THAT DECIDES IT**

Reviewers needed = submissions × reviewers per entry ÷ cap per reviewer. 155 × 3 ÷ 12 ≈ 39, so recruit about 50 to cover conflicts and drop-outs.

**ASK THE CLIENT**

Who are the appointed judges, and are they free on the judging dates? What minimum score and cap on winners do you want?